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Kukke Subramanya Temple

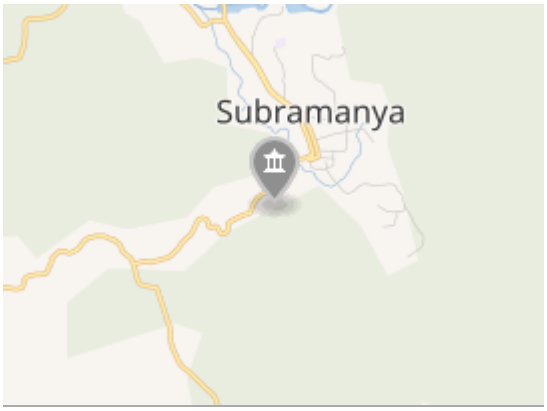
Kukke Subramanya (IAST: *Kukke Subrahmaṇya*) is a Hindu temple on the banks of Kumaradhara River in the village Subramanya in Kadaba taluk (previously in Sullia taluk) in Dakshina Kannada district, Karnataka, India.[1] Kartikeya is worshipped as Subramanya, lord of all serpents in the temple. Epics say that the divine serpent Vasuki and other serpents found refuge under Subramanya when threatened by the Garuda.The **Koojugodu Kattemane family** served as the chief administrators of the Kukke Shree Subramanya Swamy temple, managing it and exercising its chief administrative authority for generations from The Ikkeri Nayakas period until Encroachment.

The priests in the temple are Shivalli Madhwa Brahmins. The poojas and other daily rituals in the temple are performed as per Madhvacharya's *Tantra Sara Sangraha*.[2]

Kukke Subrahmanya Temple

Legend

According to legend, Kukke Subramanya is one of the seven sacred sites established by Saint Parashurama. It is the location where the divine serpent Vasuki sought refuge in Kukke Subramanya to escape Garuda, the

Kukke Subramanya Temple	
Kukke Sri Subramanya Temple	
The Gopura of the Temple	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Dakshina Kannada
Deity	Kartikeya as a Nāga
Festivals	Shasti, Kiru Shasti, Nagara Panchami, Nagaradhane
Location	
Location	On banks of river Kumaradhara
State	Karnataka
Country	India
 Interactive map of Kukke Subramanya Temple	
Coordinates	12.66°N 75.61°E
Architecture	
Style	Architecture of Karnataka
Creator	Parashurama
Website	

River in front of the temple

itms.kar.nic.in/.. (https://itms.kar.nic.in/hrcehome/index_temple.php?tid=21)

celestial bird and vehicle of Lord Vishnu. It is believed that Lord Kumaraswamy and his brother Lord Ganesha defeated the demon rulers Tharaka and Shura Padmasura at Kumara Parvatha, near Kukke Subramanya. Following his victory, Lord Kumaraswamy married Devasena, the daughter of Indra, in a grand ceremony attended by major deities, who blessed the place with divine energy.[1]

Koojugodu Kattemane Family and their Authority

The Koojugodu Kattemane family was a prominent Gowda lineage of the **Arebhashe Vokkaliga Gowda community** that historically served as the **Sankesha Adhikaris**(chief administrators) of the Kukke Subramanya Temple.[3] They traced their ancestry to Thimma Nayaka of Ikkeri and maintained close ties with both the Haleri Maharajas of Kodagu and the Dakshinayana Sringeri Sharada Peetam. The family played a key role in temple management, religious service, and establishing associated shrines within the temple premises.

The family served as the chief administrators of the temple, managing it and exercising its chief administrative authority for generations.[3]

They belonged to the *Nayar Bali gothra* of the Arebhasé Vokkaliga Gowda community and traced their ancestry to Thimma Nayaka of Ikkeri, a member of the Ikkeri royal family. The Nayakas of Ikkeri were rulers who performed **seva** (service) to Lord Subramanya.[3]

The **Ballala of Rathnapura**, who ruled parts of Kukke Patana, Harihara, Balgodu, Anekki, and Kollamogru, came into conflict with Thimma Nayaka's lineage. After a confrontation that ended the Ballala's rule, authority over the Kukke Subramanya temple passed directly to the Koojugoodu Kattemane chieftains.[3]

The **Haleri Maharajas of Kodagu** were blood relatives of the family.[3] The Koojugodu Kattemane Family was of Lingayat origin, later got converted to Arebhase Vokkaliga Gowdas.[3] The two lineages shared political, cultural, and religious ties, including agreements to exchange offerings between the Kukke Subramanya Temple in Dakshina Kannada and **Shree Bhagandeshwara Temple**, Bhagamandala in Kodagu.[3]

The family maintained close spiritual ties with the **Ubhaya Jagadgurus of the Dakshinayana Sringeri Sharada Peetam**.[3] Guided by the Jagadguru, they established the **Shree Chandramouleshwara Temple** and a Sringeri Mutt within the Kukke Subramanya temple premises. The **Shiva Linga** in the Chandramouleshwara temple was installed by the Koojugoodu Kattemane family. They continue to preserve the *Nirupa* (written order) and *Kanchina Belé* (brass plaque) presented by the Jagadguru.[3]

Notable members include:

- **Shri Shanthappa Gowda**[3]

- **Shri Kushalappa Gowda**[3]
- **Shri Venkataramana Gowda** (popularly K. V. Gowda, MLA of Puttur)[3]
- **Shri Subrahmanya Gowda** (MLA of Puttur and Belthangady)[3]

Although the family lost administrative control when the temple was taken over by the Karnataka Endowment Department,[3] they remain recognized as one of the most powerful and philanthropist Gowda families associated with Kukke Subramanya Temple.[3]

Popular rituals

The Ashlesha Bali Puja, a ritual seeking protection from black snakes, and the Sarpa Dosha Parihara, performed to remove curses associated with the snake god, are two of the most popular puja rituals conducted at the Kukke Subramanya Temple.[1]

See also

- Ghati Subramanya Temple
- Kartikay
- Kartikkeya
- Udupi
- Subramanya Matha
- Dharmasthala
- Sullia
- Mangalore
- Saarvajanika Nagabrahmastana Moodanidambooru, Bannanje

References

1. "Kukke Subramanya Temple" (https://karnatakatourism.org/tour-item/kukke-subramanya-temple/). Karnataka Tourism, Govt of Karnataka.
2. *Karnataka State Gazetteer: Shimoga* (https://books.google.com/books?id=RrG1AAAAIAAJ). Director of Print, Stationery and Publications at the Government Press, Karnataka (India). 1973. p. 105.
3. Puttur Anantharaja Gowda. *In Pursuit of Our Roots*. Bengaluru: Tenkila Publications, First Edition, 23 February 2015. Available at: Archive.org (https://archive.org/embed/arebhashe.inpursuitofourro0000putt)

External links

- Temple's Official Website (http://www.kukke.org/) Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20121118005919/http://www.kukke.org/) 18 November 2012 at the Wayback Machine

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